



The Selectboard
TOWN OF WESTHAMPTON
TOWN HALL
1 SOUTH ROAD
WESTHAMPTON, MASSACHUSETTS 01027

MINUTES of the MEETING

Monday, August 29, 2022, at 7:00 PM

The Westhampton Selectboard scheduled a regular meeting to be held on Monday, August 29, 2022, at 7:00 PM at the Town Offices, 1 South Road, and via video-conference.¹

Call to Order

The meeting was called to order at 7:05 PM by Maureen Dempsey, chair pro tem.

PRESENT: Maureen Dempsey, Scott Johndrow (arrived at 7:06 PM)

ALSO PRESENT: Julia Peters, Paul Fenn, Douglas Finn.

PRESENT BY REMOTE CONFERENCING: Phil Dowling, Patty Cotton, Robby Armenti, Charles and Mary Lou Burgess

Local Power - "New Paradigms for Non-Recyclable Solid Waste Management"

Ms. Julia Peters, and Mr. Paul Fenn, from Local Power LLC, made a presentation to the Board in regard to potential options for the town.

Mr. Fenn: Local Power is based in Haydenville. The company received a question in regard to Community Choice Aggregation. Mr. Fenn described the practice and impacts of Community Choice Aggregation.

Mr. Fenn noted that Local Power is working on a form of CCA that relates to solid waste management. That type of CCA allows communities to consider the power and energy relative to solid waste management.

Mr. Fenn advised that the town should start rethinking solid waste management, particularly non-recyclable or non-compostable waste.

Mr. Fenn described the concerns of PFAS and PFOS – so-called “Forever Chemicals” – that persist in the environment and the natural food chains.

Mr. Fenn noted that current practice is to ship landfill and incineration waste to poor communities in other states, and suggested that practice was not only non-sustainable, but also unethical.

The challenge to incineration is that toxicity remains in the exhaust, with deleterious impacts.

Mr. Fenn noted that a new process converts solid waste to ‘White Hydrogen’, destroys PFAS, and leaves carbon char, which can be reutilized safely.

¹ Pursuant to Chapter 20 of the Acts of 2021, the meeting was conducted as a "hybrid" (in-person / remote) meeting. Members of the public could access the meeting in person, or connect via "zoom" teleconferencing via internet – Meeting ID#: 870 4390 0582.

Mr. Fenn spoke about carbon emissions since the 1990s, and described US progress in that area as ‘dismal’.

Mr. Fenn further spoke about their proposal, and an established relationship with “Ways To H”, and described a timeline for the outreach, development of a site, and implementation of contracts, agreements, and construction of a facility.

Mr. Dowling: Where has this type of process been implemented? Mr. Fenn: Facilities online in Japan, and in Europe over the past few years.

Ms. Dempsey: How does the process work? Mr. Fenn: We can send the specs to you.

Mr. David Wasielewski: The cost of shipping solid waste to out-of-state destinations is unsustainable.

Ms. Dempsey confirmed that more information would be sent. Ms. Peters also noted that a draft letter of interest would be sent along as well.

Mr. Johndrow asked for links to media.

Mr. Fenn and Ms. Peters were thanked for their time.

Department and Committee Updates

Highway (Bill Jablonski)

Mr. Jablonski was not present. Mr. Finn noted that Mr. Jablonski was working on nailing down a date for the paving at the public safety complex.

Health (Robby Armenti)

Ms. Armenti submitted a report. No questions.

Public Safety Building (Phil Dowling, Steve Holt)

Mr. Dowling noted that sheetrock work continued; the sprinkler system was being installed. Some painting has been done. Mr. Johndrow: Estimate of completion? Mr. Holt: End of October. Work continues at an increased rate, and that date seems realistic. Mr. Holt noted that he is seeing significant work happening, even finish painting and exterior lighting fixtures.

MVP (Teri Anderson)

No report -- Ms. Anderson was not present.

New Business (may include items not reasonably anticipated at time of posting)

Police Department – Request for Background Check / Appointment

A letter from Chief White was reviewed, requesting permission from the appointing authority to start a background on a police applicant. Chief White noted that the applicant, Mr. Jason Graham, lives in town, is a full time Deputy with the Sheriff's Office and has completed the bridge academy. The chief requested permission to proceed with the background check, noting that the formal background is a requirement of Police Reform. Further, the chief recommended Mr. Graham for appointment as an officer.

Mr. Dowling recommended proceeding with the background check.

It was MOVED by Dowling, SECONDED by Johndrow

To grant approval for conducting the background check as a prerequisite of appointment.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (7:33 PM)

“JAWS”, 0 Main Road – Ongoing Cleanup

Some correspondence was presented in regard to a resident complaint, and followup action by the Building Commissioner. There was some discussion on the matter. Mr. Dowling noted that he was planning to do a flyover with his drone to compare to footage from 2020, to determine if progress is actually moving forward. There was some discussion related to whether the site is still active, and if the operation is still working from that site. The hope is that the cleanup is continuing.

Mr. Dowling also noted that he visited the site some months before, and reported on the apparent activity seen at that time.

Information / Correspondence

Review FY22 Reports from Accountant (see materials files)

Reports from the Town Accountant were reviewed.

Mr. Dowling noted that he had been in communication with Town Accountant; Ms. Patty Cotton had been able to reconcile accounts through April; however, the reports have been properly submitted to the Accountant's office only through March.

Mr. Johndrow: have we received weekly reports? Mr. Dowling, not as of yet.

Mr. Dowling requested a meeting sometime after Labor Day, to discuss the matter, and have the option for an executive session at that same meeting.

The board agreed to meet on the Wednesday, 7th of September, 7 PM.

Review Correspondence (see materials files)

A letter from Barbara Pellesier, related to food-waste composting. There was ranging discussion, with the end result being the interest in speaking with the HRMC about the possibilities. Mr. Finn will connect with Bill Jablonski and the HRMC to arrange a presentation and future discussion.

Review of Payroll and A/P Warrants

Payroll and A/P Warrants were received. After review, it was MOVED by Johndrow SECONDED by Dowling

To approve the WP23-05 Payroll.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (7:48 PM)

It was MOVED by Johndrow, SECONED by Dowling

To approve the W23-05 A/P Warrant as presented.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (7:49 PM)

Review / Approve Minutes

August 15, 2022

Mr. Finn presented copies of draft minutes from August 15, 2022. The Chair postponed a vote on approval to the next regular meeting.

Set date for next meeting(s)

Meetings are scheduled for September 7, 2022, 7 PM, as well as the next regular meeting on September 12, 2022.

Adjourn

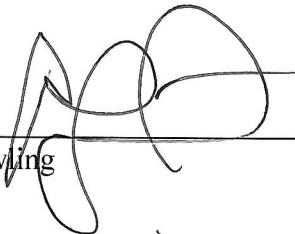
There being no further business, it was MOVED by Johndrow, SECONDED by Dowling
To adjourn.

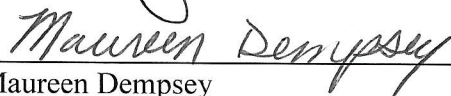
NO OBJECTION. (7:51 PM)

Respectfully submitted,

Douglas C. Finn

Approved by a vote of the Selectboard at a regular meeting, held on September 12, 2022.



Phil Dowling

Maureen Dempsey

Scott Johndrow